■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, July 28, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (2 stories)

■ *Netanyahu's Canadian Detour: Permission or Secret Flight?*

The Angle: *Israel claims it asked Canada for permission to let Netanyahu use Canadian airspace to meet Trump—but Ottawa won't say whether they approved it or how he got through. It's a major diplomatic tension between allies, especially given the ICC arrest warrant situation.*

- **Israel told CBC News** it requested permission for **Netanyahu** to overfly **Newfoundland and Nova Scotia** on Monday
- Netanyahu was en route to a meeting with **U.S. President Donald Trump**
- **Canadian officials are refusing to comment** on whether they granted permission or how Netanyahu entered/exited Canadian airspace

The Diplomatic Standoff

- Should Canada be forced to ground Netanyahu because of the ICC warrant, or is letting him transit quietly the right diplomatic move?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/netanyahu-flight-canadian-airspace-9.7288211?cmp=rss

■ *Netanyahu defies arrest calls, confirms New York visit*

The Angle: *Israel's PM is pushing back hard against activists demanding his arrest when he lands in NYC—a high-stakes showdown over international law, immunity, and whose voice counts in America's biggest city.*

- **Netanyahu** declared he's **'definitely'** going to New York despite activist pressure
- **Mamdani** (activist/commentator) publicly called for Netanyahu's arrest, saying he's not welcome in NYC
- Netanyahu fired back, calling Mamdani's message **'hate-spewing'**

The Question

- Should the U.S. be a platform for arresting foreign leaders over international disputes—or is that crossing a line?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/28/us-news/netanyahu-says-hes-definitely-going-to-new-york-despite-hate-spewing-mamdanis-call-for-his-arrest/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Powerful Japan earthquake kills 13, rescue ops underway*

The Angle: *A major earthquake has hit Japan triggering fires, building collapses, and widespread damage—rescue teams are actively searching for survivors in the rubble. It's a developing story with real human stakes and the kind of natural disaster that dominates news cycles across North America.*

- At least **13 people killed** in the earthquake
- The quake sparked **multiple fires** across the region
- **Buildings collapsed** and **bridges sustained damage**
- A **freight train was capsized** by the tremor

The Reality Check

- Have you got family or friends in Japan right now, or experienced a major quake yourself—what was that like?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/search-for-survivors-japan-quake-kills-13

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Twitter user sparks debate with controversial hot take*

The Angle: *A viral X post is dividing the internet over an opinion that's got people either nodding or rolling their eyes hard—classic internet discourse that's worth unpacking on air.*

The Hot Take Challenge

- What's a take you've seen online recently that made you immediately disagree—or surprised you because you actually agreed?

X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/WomenBeingAwful/status/2082210918604112255

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Willie Nelson declares war on data centers*

The Angle: *The country-music icon is calling out the rapid sprawl of AI-powered data centers across rural America, claiming they're environmental disasters. It's a rare celebrity voice pushing back on Big Tech's infrastructure boom in a way that actually resonates with his fanbase and land-rights advocates.*

- **Willie Nelson** has publicly opposed data center construction across the U.S.
- He's calling data centers **"loud, water thieving, light polluting"** facilities
- **Nelson** says they "only destroy the environment around them"
- He's encouraging citizens to actively fight the proliferation of these facilities

The Celebrity Call-Out

- Should we care what Willie Nelson thinks about data centers—or is this proof that even our heroes are starting to see Big Tech's real cost?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2082232517084827707

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ *Shopify CEO's wild take: pay more taxes, get more votes*

The Angle: *A billionaire tech exec just endorsed a voting system where wealth determines how much your ballot counts—and it's sparking a massive debate about democracy, inequality, and whether rich guys should just keep their takes offline.*

- **Tobi Lütke**, CEO of **Shopify**, replied positively to a proposal for **'weighted voting proportional to income tax paid'**
- Under the proposed system: **no votes for non-taxpayers, up to five votes for anyone paying $500,000+ in annual taxes**
- The post has triggered backlash, with critics calling it an attack on **one-person-one-vote democracy**

The Hypothetical Gone Wrong

- If you paid more in taxes, should you literally get to vote more than your neighbor—yes or no, and where's the line?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Premise** - Set it up (30 seconds) -> Host A reads Lütke's endorsement of weighted voting. Host B reacts with disbelief.
- **Step 2: The Reductio** - Push it to the absurd (1 min) -> Hosts riff on what else you could weight votes by—income, education, home value, social media followers. Watch it fall apart.
- **Step 3: The Caller Gauntlet** - Open the lines (5-7 min) -> Take calls: Does wealth = better judgment? Should democracy be one-person-one-vote no matter what? Is this just billionaire delusion?
- **Step 4: The Landing** - Close it out (1 min) -> Host takeaway: Why billionaires floating anti-democratic ideas keeps happening, and why it matters that people push back.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/shopify-ceo-appears-to-endorse-giving-more-votes-to-wealthy-canadians-9.7286688?cmp=rss

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■ *FIFA's $20 billion World Cup power play sparks major backlash*

The Angle: *FIFA just announced a massive private company to run the World Cup with **Jared Kushner** and other major investors involved — and Europe's soccer governing body is already furious about it. This is a fundamental shift in how the world's biggest sporting event gets controlled and monetized.*

- **FIFA president Gianni Infantino** unveiled a plan to create a **$20 billion US company** to operate the World Cup going forward
- The operation would include private investors, among them members of the **Kushner family**
- **UEFA**, Europe's soccer governing body, immediately attacked the plan

The Takeover Question

- Should a private company—especially one tied to the Kushners—have control over the World Cup, or does FIFA have the right to hand it off?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/soccer/fifa-ownership-infantino-uefa-anger-july28-9.7287575?cmp=rss

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■■ *Former MP Chris Alexander officially entering Toronto's mayoral race*

The Angle: *Former MP Chris Alexander officially entering Toronto's mayoral race*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/former-mp-chris-alexander-running-for-toronto-mayor-9.7288453?cmp=rss

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■ *Canadian government removes cap on online passport renewals*

The Angle: *Canadian government removes cap on online passport renewals*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/online-passport-renewal-canada-9.7287458?cmp=rss

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■ *RCMP under investigation after officer punches woman repeatedly*

The Angle: *Saskatchewan's police watchdog is now probing a use-of-force incident on a First Nation reserve where an RCMP officer allegedly punched a woman multiple times in the face—raising fresh questions about policing practices and accountability in Indigenous communities.*

- **Saskatchewan's police oversight body** is investigating the incident
- The incident occurred on **Makwa Sahgaiehcan First Nation**
- An **RCMP officer** is alleged to have **punched a woman several times in the face**
- The woman's family is questioning the **use of force** in the encounter

The Accountability Question

- When police oversight investigations happen after an incident like this, what actually changes—and should families and communities expect real consequences or just an inquiry?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/indigenous/makwa-sahgaiehcan-arrest-video-9.7287817?cmp=rss

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■ *Ontario NDP leader says Premier Ford 'has the answers' about what's in soot blanketing Hamilton communities*

The Angle: *Ontario NDP leader says Premier Ford 'has the answers' about what's in soot blanketing Hamilton communities*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/hamilton/soot-in-hamilton-9.7287695?cmp=rss

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■ *White House taunts Katy Perry with another video after her Firework rebuke*

The Angle: *White House taunts Katy Perry with another video after her Firework rebuke*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/trump-katy-perry-part-of-me-tiktok-9.7287529?cmp=rss

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■ *U.S. and Saudi forces strike back at Iran-backed militants in Iraq*

The Angle: *After Iran-backed groups launched more than two dozen drone attacks, the U.S. and Saudi Arabia are escalating their response in Iraq—raising fresh questions about how far this tit-for-tat cycle will go in the Middle East.*

- **Iran-backed militants** launched **more than two dozen drone attacks** that triggered the U.S. and Saudi response
- **U.S. and Saudi forces** jointly conducted strikes targeting what they're calling **'terrorist' groups** operating in Iraq
- The strikes represent a direct military escalation following the drone campaign

The Escalation Question

- How many rounds of 'he hit us, so we hit back' does it take before this stops being tit-for-tat and becomes a real conflict?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/u-s-saudi-forces-strike-iran-backed-terrorists-in-iraq-u-s-military

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■ *Commanders tap Wes Welker to replace tight ends coach fired after DWI arrest*

The Angle: *Commanders tap Wes Welker to replace tight ends coach fired after DWI arrest*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/29/sports/commanders-tap-wes-welker-to-replace-tight-ends-coach-fired-after-dwi-arrest/

■ *PGA Tour golfers forced to cross US-Canada border — and back again — after Korean BBQ mixup*

The Angle: *PGA Tour golfers forced to cross US-Canada border — and back again — after Korean BBQ mixup*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/28/sports/michael-kim-si-woo-kim-forced-to-cross-us-canada-border-after-korean-bbq-mixup/

■■ *Hero teen lifeguard who saved boy from pounding California surf rescued others that day, family reveals*

The Angle: *Hero teen lifeguard who saved boy from pounding California surf rescued others that day, family reveals*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/28/us-news/teen-lifeguard-who-saved-boy-at-norcal-beach-rescued-others-that-day/

■ *It could 'be over' for J.J. McCarthy with Vikings as Kyler Murray may have edge in QB battle*

The Angle: *It could 'be over' for J.J. McCarthy with Vikings as Kyler Murray may have edge in QB battle*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/28/sports/it-could-be-over-for-j-j-mccarthy-with-vikings/

■ *Gerrit Cole delivers another strong outing as hot Yankees nip White Sox*

The Angle: *Gerrit Cole delivers another strong outing as hot Yankees nip White Sox*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/28/sports/gerrit-cole-delivers-strong-outing-as-yankees-nip-white-sox/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■■ *Shopify CEO faces backlash over wealth-based voting idea*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Shopify CEO criticizing democratic voting principles taps into wealth inequality discourse that's been building momentum and will likely attract stronger engagement as story develops.

The Angle: *The billionaire head of a major Canadian e-commerce company is getting roasted on social media for what looks like support for a system where richer people get more votes—a suggestion that's reigniting the whole debate about whether money should buy political power.*

- **Shopify CEO** is facing public criticism for apparent comments supporting **wealth-based voting power**
- The backlash is happening across social media with widespread discussion of the controversial idea
- The proposal would fundamentally alter democratic voting principles by tying political representation to financial status

The Hot Take

- Should your bank account determine how much your vote counts—and what does it say about billionaires that some of them think it should?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Premise Check** - 30 seconds -> Host A reads the CEO's apparent stance straight; Host B reacts with disbelief—establish what we're actually talking about here.
- **Step 2: The Slippery Slope** - 1 minute -> Hosts riff on where this goes: if money = votes, what's the threshold? $100K? $1M? Do kids with trust funds vote twice? Get absurd with it, then snap back to the actual problem.
- **Step 3: Call the Lines** - Open phones, 2-3 minutes -> Ask listeners: Have you ever heard a rich person casually suggest the system should work in their favor? Or: What would YOU tie voting power to instead—education? Social media followers? Go.

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2082242238088626395

■ *White House Bans Foreign Humanoid Robots in Bid to Slow China's Tech Explosion https://t.co/z3WRfJY6Xo*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): White House banning foreign humanoid robots is a concrete geopolitical move with direct China-tech competition angle that plays into emerging U.S.-China tech war coverage trending hard right now.
The Angle: *White House Bans Foreign Humanoid Robots in Bid to Slow China's Tech Explosion https://t.co/z3WRfJY6Xo*

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2082248512339587177

■ *Gold medal figure skater Amber Glenn reveals that she owns "well over 100,000 cards" in her Magic: The Gathering collection:*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Olympic figure skater owning 100K+ Magic cards is a novel crossover angle between elite athletics and nerd culture that has genuine human interest and shareable surprise factor.
The Angle: *Gold medal figure skater Amber Glenn reveals that she owns "well over 100,000 cards" in her Magic: The Gathering collection:*

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2082287493895094401

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 7 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)
- "Lake Tahoe home invaded by creepy squatter as bizarre details emerge" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Liberty's Betnijah Laney-Hamilton ejected for throwing teammate's shoe at opponent in bizarre scene" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Mike Tyson makes bizarre Shohei Ohtani remark at ESPYs" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Firefighters rescue man from s–tty situation after he gets trapped in porta-potty in Kansas City" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 39 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After 'Bottle Rocket' Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "'Rent' West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)
- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)
- "Gen Z Leans Hard into Nostalgia to Spur Music and Content Discovery: Study" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Nike Releases New Limited-Edition Air Jordan 7 Retro 'Miró' Sneakers: Here's Where To Buy a Pair Online" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Thousands of 'Pokémon Go' Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED" (Wired (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for 'Reasonable Doubt' 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-11)

- "Karlovy Vary Film Fest Awards Go to ‘Fruit Gathering,’ ‘The Guest,’ ‘Lover, Not a Fighter’ and ‘Incinerator’" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Hilary Duff Delights With Equal Parts Nostalgia and Evolution on The Lucky Me Tour: “Joyful, Fun and Extremely Rewarding”" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates ‘The Blueprint’ 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Eagle-eyed fans spot haunting detail in ‘RHOA’ Cynthia Bailey’s photo" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium https://t.co/tUvxpPLa9c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Who Can Begrudge Gen Z Nostalgia For an Era Before They Were Born?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Emerging Directors Need to Be ‘Brave,’ ‘Curious,’ ‘Pushy’ and ‘Fearless,’ Say Industry Leaders Behind Future Frames Program" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "‘Cats: The Jellicle Ball’ Ending Broadway Run in August" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-13)
- "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has Longchamp, Coach and more of stars’ favorite handbags up to 50% off" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-lister-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Google Images Is Trying to Be… Pinterest?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale has deep discounts on Free People — including a Taylor Swift-worn skirt" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Factories Now Ready for iPhone 20's Glass Redesign, Leaker Claims - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-15)
- "‘Goodbye, Lara’ Is Easily the Most Enchanting Fairy Tale Reimagining You’ll Watch This Year" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "The last time the sword-and-sandal epic truly conquered the Oscars was "Gladiator."" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-17)
- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: ‘Your love will forever be woven into who we are’" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)
- "‘Scrubs’ Revival Ups Ava Bunn to Series Regular, X Mayo and Joel Kim Booster Exit - Variety" (Variety (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "The Beauty Finds I’m Buying During Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale - The Cut" (The Cut (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "‘La La Land’ 10th Anniversary Poster Finally Corrects Ryan Gosling’s Flat Hand" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-21)
- "‘Harry Potter’ Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature ‘Sorcerer’s Stone’ 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)
- "LISTEN: Reba McEntire Revels in 50 Years of Making Music and Season 3 of NBC’s ‘Happy’s Place’" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale Is a Goldmine of Jewelry Markdowns — Here Are the 23 Standouts" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Here’s How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band’s 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said ‘Absolutely No Goddamn AI’ in ‘Pan’s Labyrinth’ 3D Re-Release: ‘We’re Protecting a Lineage of Art’" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah’s ‘favorites’ at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from ‘ultra-flattering’ pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "‘Star Trek: Starfleet Academy’ Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)

- "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 20 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-29 12:21 AM